

with croûtons

Small dice of fried bread are a classic garnish. For about 40 croûtons, cut 4 slices of day-old white bread (crusts removed) into ½in (1cm) dice. Heat 2 tbsp olive oil and 2 tbsp unsalted butter in a large frying pan until hot, then cook the bread, stirring constantly, for 10 minutes or until golden. Drain on paper towels before serving. For extra flavor, stir in a finely chopped garlic clove a few minutes before the croûtons are through cooking.

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Large croûtons are known as croûtes. To make them, cut a day-old baguette into ½in (1cm) slices, and toast until golden. Alternatively, place on a baking sheet and bake in an oven preheated to 350˚F (180˚C) for 15 minutes.

ways of serving croûtes



Croûtes are a versatile garnish. Rubbed with garlic, then topped with cheese and popped under the broiler, they are perfect for French onion soup (above). For fish soups, spread them thickly with a garlicky rouille sauce.